

Burners Experience

You keep what you kill.

XP for treasure wrested from the dungeon and for monsters overcome there. The Referee keeps the totals and does not say them.

Level up when your XP hits the next line on the table and you have gained the four Traits for that level, the next time you wake after sleeping somewhere safe (town, inn, watched camp). Traits come one slot per session you attend, filled in play, so XP alone does not level you (see *Gaining Traits* in [[Burners Adventure Game]]). When you have the four Traits, ask the Referee, “*Do I have enough?*” The answer is yes or not yet. Put the level in the Approach those four Traits sit under. Reroll HP (one d6 per character level) and keep the higher of the new total or old+1. See *Approach Level* and *HP* in [[Burners Adventure Game]].

The deed pays the XP, not the finding. Coin in your purse is for spending — kit, drink, retainers. That is its own reward.

Level	XP	Eldar XP
1	0	0
2	2,000	4,000
3	4,000	8,000
4	8,000	16,000
5	16,000	32,000
6	32,000	64,000
7	64,000	128,000
8	120,000	240,000

Totals are cumulative. Leftover XP carries past a level, so nothing is lost by not knowing the number.

Treasure. 1 XP per 1 gp of treasure wrested from the dungeon — coin, gems, jewelry, goods, art — credited at the deed that wrested it (see *The deed pays*). Town pays coin, never XP.

Monsters. When you overcome them — killed, routed, or otherwise put down. The Referee sets the XP. A foe with nothing to guard should still pay what it was worth to beat.

Their own reward. No XP, whether you take them or leave them:

- **Magic items**, enchanted fixtures included. The item is the reward.
- **Weapons, armor, and tools** — blades, harness, shields, rope, lanterns, boats. You got the thing.
- **Monster parts** — hide, tusks, venom, grave-dust. The kill already paid; cutting it up does not pay again (see *Part out*).
- **Bounties.** Town coin for a deed. The kill already paid its XP.
- **Keeps, ships, and land.** You hold them.

Some of these sell. The coin is purse money, not XP.

Eldar

[[Burners Ancestry|Eldar]] use the Eldar column (double XP). Two Signatures per character level instead of one, still earned in play. Ancestry is why those can be gifts a mortal cannot take (low light, charm, sleep, and so on).

Who gets a share

Per fight and per deed — not per game night.

- **Monster:** who was there when it went down. Left before, or walked up after: no cut.
- **Treasure:** who was there for the deed that wrested it free.

OSE base. Split that pot evenly among Burners and retainers on the job who are **not** Mustering. Each counts as one in the divisor. Non-Mustering retainers keep **half** of that share (OSE); throw the rest away. Do not put half-shares in the divisor.

Muster (Heart Boss). A key Boss benefit: bring Mustering retainers **without taxing party XP**. They are **not** in the divisor. After the Boss's share is set, Mustering retainers on that job take **half of their Boss's XP, split evenly** among them (round down). One Mustering retainer gets the whole half; three split it three ways. The Boss keeps their full share. See [[Burners Muster]].

Treasure **pay** is separate: living retainers expect a half-share of the coin. If the crew skips them, the Referee says so ([[Burners Muster]]).

The deed pays

Treasure pays XP when it is wrested from the grasp of the dungeon — a monster, a trap, a lock, the tide, the deep itself. Robbing folk in town, looting a camp you scared off, killing townsfolk or their animals: no XP. Foes who come at you with steel in the wild — bandits, raiders, pirates — are foes like any monster, and what they guard counts.

- **Kill a guardian where it keeps its hoard** and you earn its XP plus everything in its grasp at that moment, whether or not anyone ever finds it. You must be in the lair or right by the treasure: the same chamber, the coffin it rose from, the nest at its back. The same dungeon is not enough. Finding the hoard later gives you the gold.
- **Kill it away from its hoard** — at the lair's mouth, in the next corridor, a hundred miles off — and you earn its XP only.
- **A gatekeeper guards the door, not the dungeon.** Its XP and what it kept at the gate. The rooms beyond pay when you get to them.
- **Beat a trap, a lock, or a deadly crossing** into the room it guards and you earn the treasure in that room, taken or not. The trap itself pays nothing.
- **Sneak past a guardian, or go around a trap,** and you earn XP only for what you carry off, when you take it.
- **Treasure loose in a room nothing guards** — in the silt, under the tide — pays when taken, to those there.
- **Undefended treasure pays nothing.** If nothing stands between the world and a hoard, carrying it off is just picking it up. Gold, not XP.

Staking a claim. Enter a lair while its guardian lives, and come out alive, and you have staked a claim on that hoard. If the guardian later dies or leaves by any means, those who staked the claim earn the hoard when they go back and take it. Nobody else does. How it died does not matter; the only question is whether you were in its lair while it lived.

Credited once. Each gold piece is credited exactly once, at the deed, to those there for it. Finding already-credited loot later pays gold, not XP: “*That was already credited to the people who wrested it free.*”

Situation	Kill XP	Treasure XP
Kill it beside its hoard	Yes	Yes, at the kill, found or not
Kill it far from its hoard	Yes	No; the hoard waits
Kill the gatekeeper, never go in	Yes	Only what it kept at the gate
Sneak past and take part of the hoard	No	Only what you took
Beat the trap or lock into the room	—	Yes, all of that room, taken or not
Beat a trap with nothing behind it	—	No
Take treasure loose in an unguarded room	—	Yes, when taken
Guardian died elsewhere; you braved its lair while it lived	—	Yes, when you take the hoard
Guardian died elsewhere; you never faced it there	—	No
Find already-credited loot	No	No
Rob or kill folk in town	No	No

The Referee sets each find’s gp once, now or later. Unknown gp does not block the credit.

Part out

You may strip a kill for salvage — hide, tusks, ivory, and so on. Some of it sells (the Referee sets the gp). Some of it is just useful — rope from sinew, a shield from shell, oil from blubber, a reagent in the sack. Either way: purse or kit, **not XP**. The fight already paid; cutting the carcass does not pay again.

Who tracks what

Referee. XP per Burner and retainer, and who was there for each fight and deed. Keep the totals behind the screen. When a player has their four Traits and asks “*Do I have enough?*”, answer yes or not yet; if not yet keeps coming, give a rough distance (*about halfway, close*), not the number. Keep a master treasure list: what each foe guards, its full value at the kill, and who it was credited to, so a later find is gold only. After you describe a find, do not re-list the treasure for the players. Speak for retainers owed a cut.

Players. Track your Traits, your pending Trait slots and the moments that will fill them, the sessions you attended, and your level. Track what you took, how you split or stowed it, and what you spent. Unlogged finds are not available to spend until you account for them.